Lab - Using Access Keys with Azure Storage Explorer
To Begin with the Lab

Summary

This lab demonstrates how to connect **Azure Storage Explorer** to an Azure Storage Account using **Access Keys**. By using the storage account name and access key, you can browse and manage blobs, files, queues, and tables without using Azure AD authentication.

Understanding

Azure Storage Explorer is a desktop application used to manage Azure Storage resources. It allows you to connect to a Storage Account using an **Access Key**, a **Connection String**, **SAS Token**, or **Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD)**.

When you use an **Access Key**, Storage Explorer authenticates directly with the Storage Account, giving you full access to all storage services. This method is useful for administrators, testing, and scenarios where Azure AD authentication is not available.

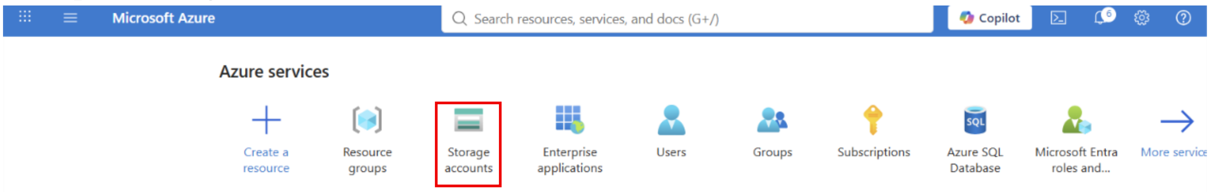
Example:

Suppose you have a Storage Account named **cloudxuesstorage**. You copy the account name and one of its access keys from the Azure Portal. In Azure Storage Explorer, you select **Use a storage account name and key**, enter the details, and successfully connect. You can then upload, download, create, or delete blobs from the storage account.

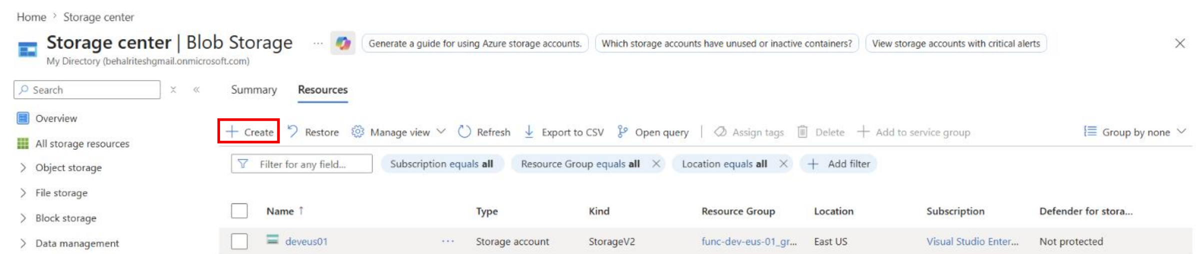
Lab Steps

Step 1: Create a Storage Account

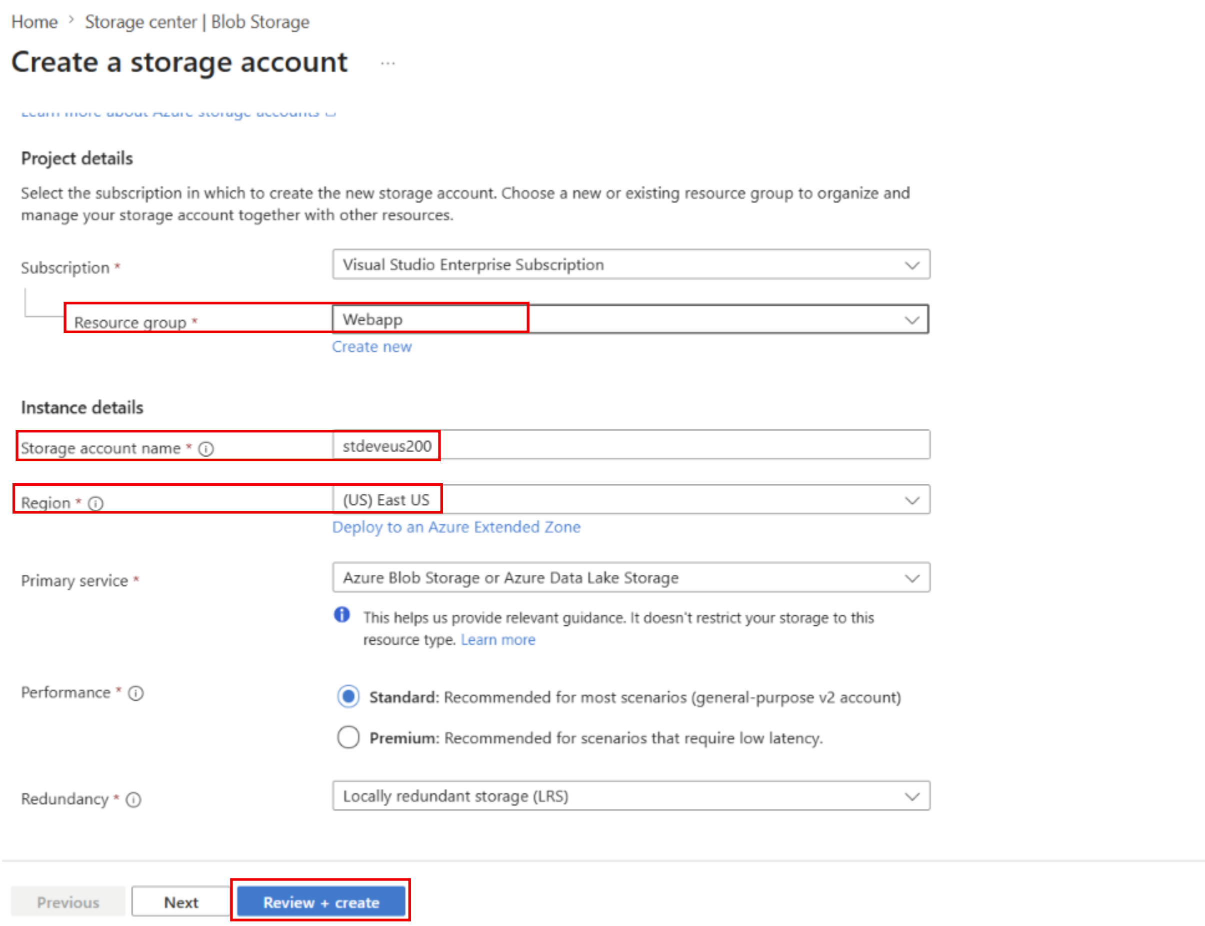
- Go to the Azure Portal.
- Open **Storage Accounts**.



- Click **Create**.

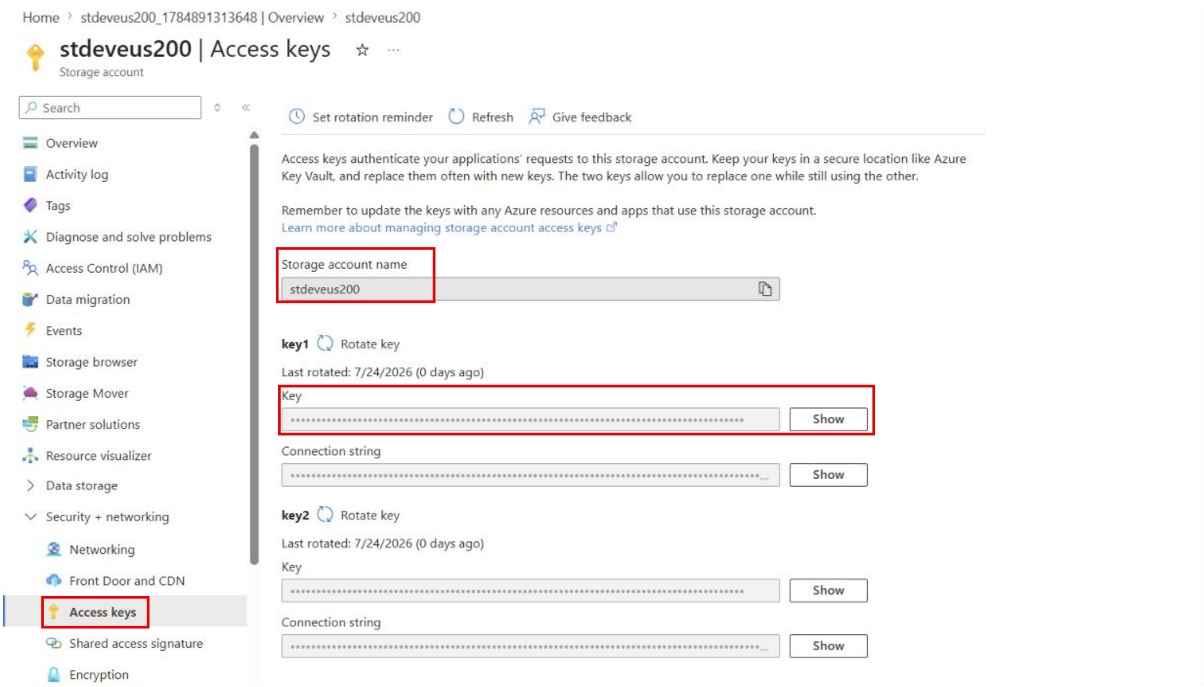


- Select the Subscription and **Resource Group**.
- Enter a **unique Storage Account name**.
- Choose the **Region** and Performance.
- Click **Review + Create**.
- Click **Create**.



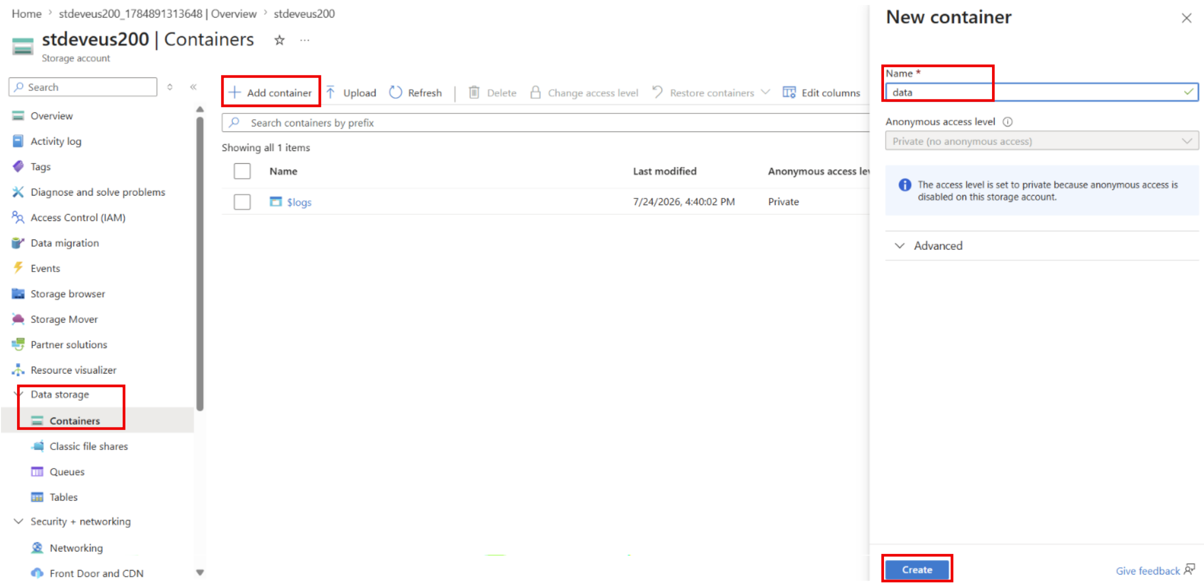
Step 2: Retrieve the Access Key

- Open the Storage Account.
- Navigate to **Security + networking**.
- Click **Access keys**.
- Copy the **Storage Account Name**.
- Copy **Key1** or **Key2**.



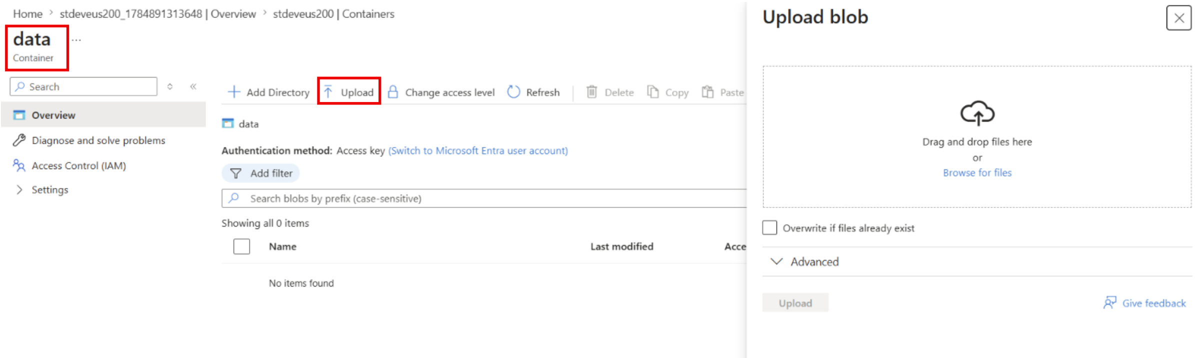
Step 3: Add Container

- Go to the **Data Storage**.
- Navigate to **Container.**
- Click on the **Add container**.
- Enter the **container Name (data)**.
- Click on the **Create**.

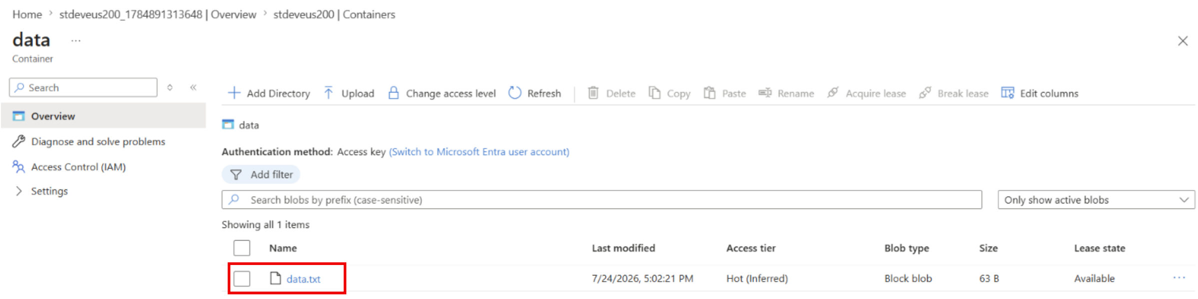


Step 4: upload file in Container

- Open the just add **data container**.
- Click on the **Upload.**
- Click on the **Browse for Files**



- Uploaded **any File.**

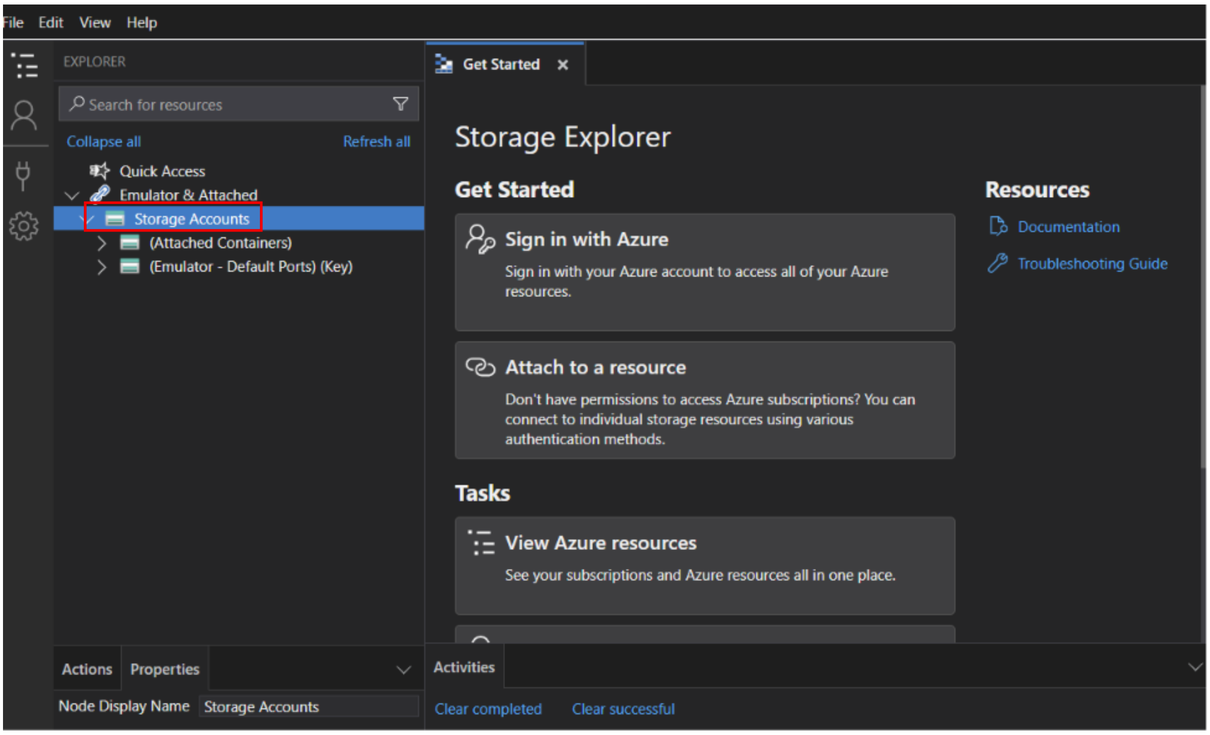


Step 3: Install Azure Storage Explorer

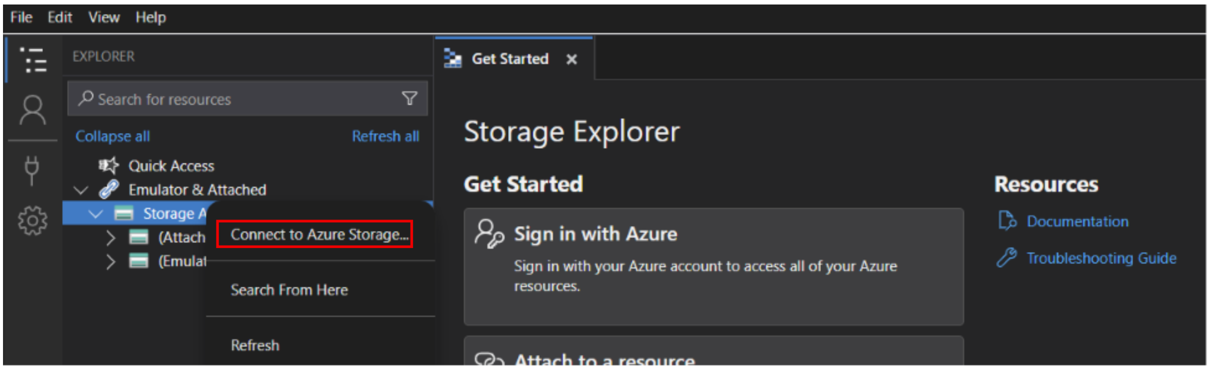
- Download and **install Azure Storage Explorer**.
- Launch the application.
- Wait for the application to load.

Step 4: Add a Storage Account

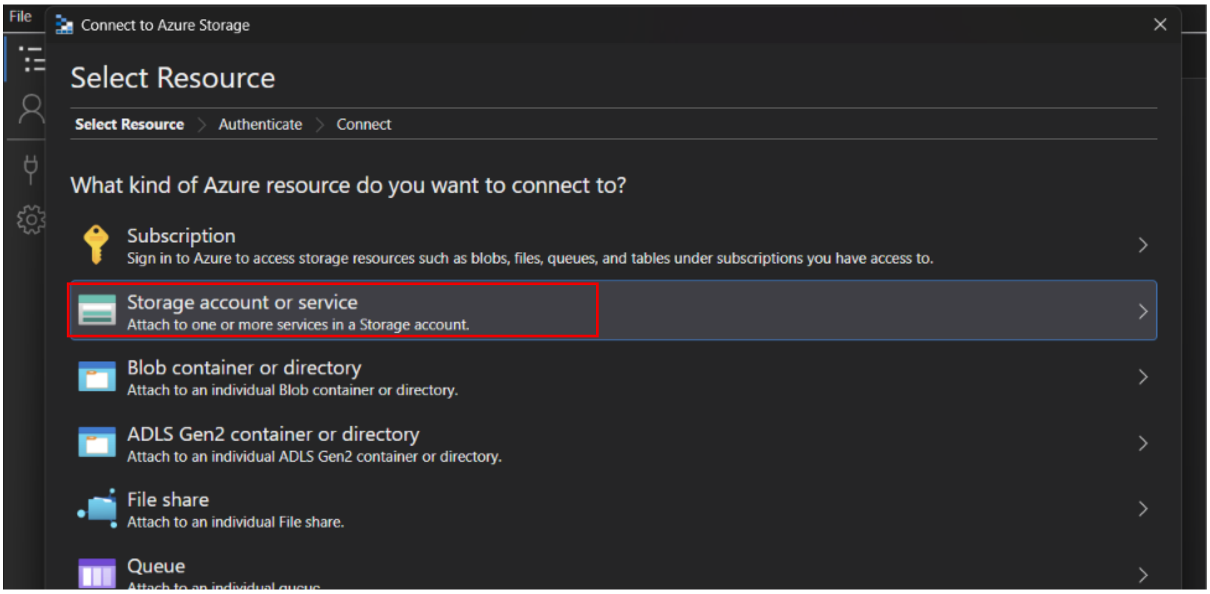
- (**Right click**) on Storage Account.



- Click **Connect**.



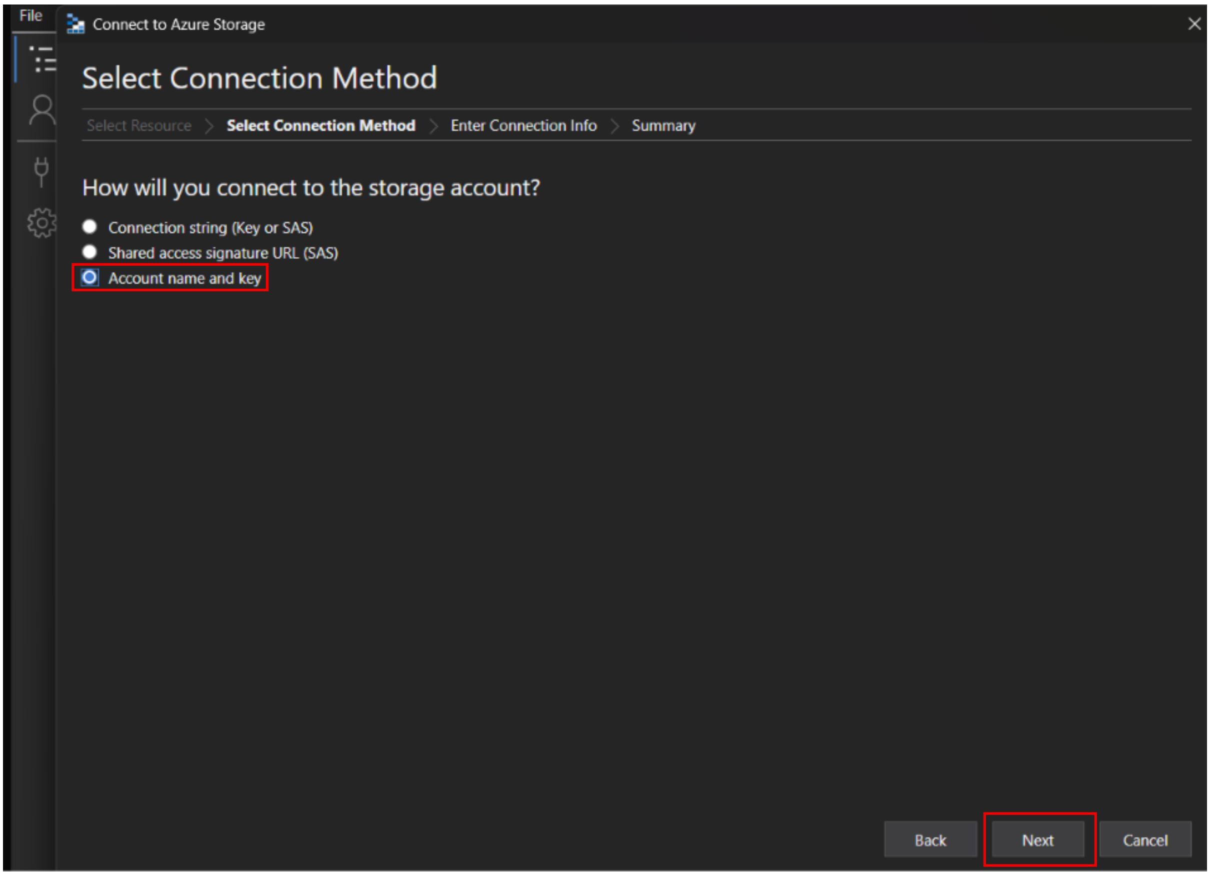
- Select **Storage account or service**.



- Click **Next**.

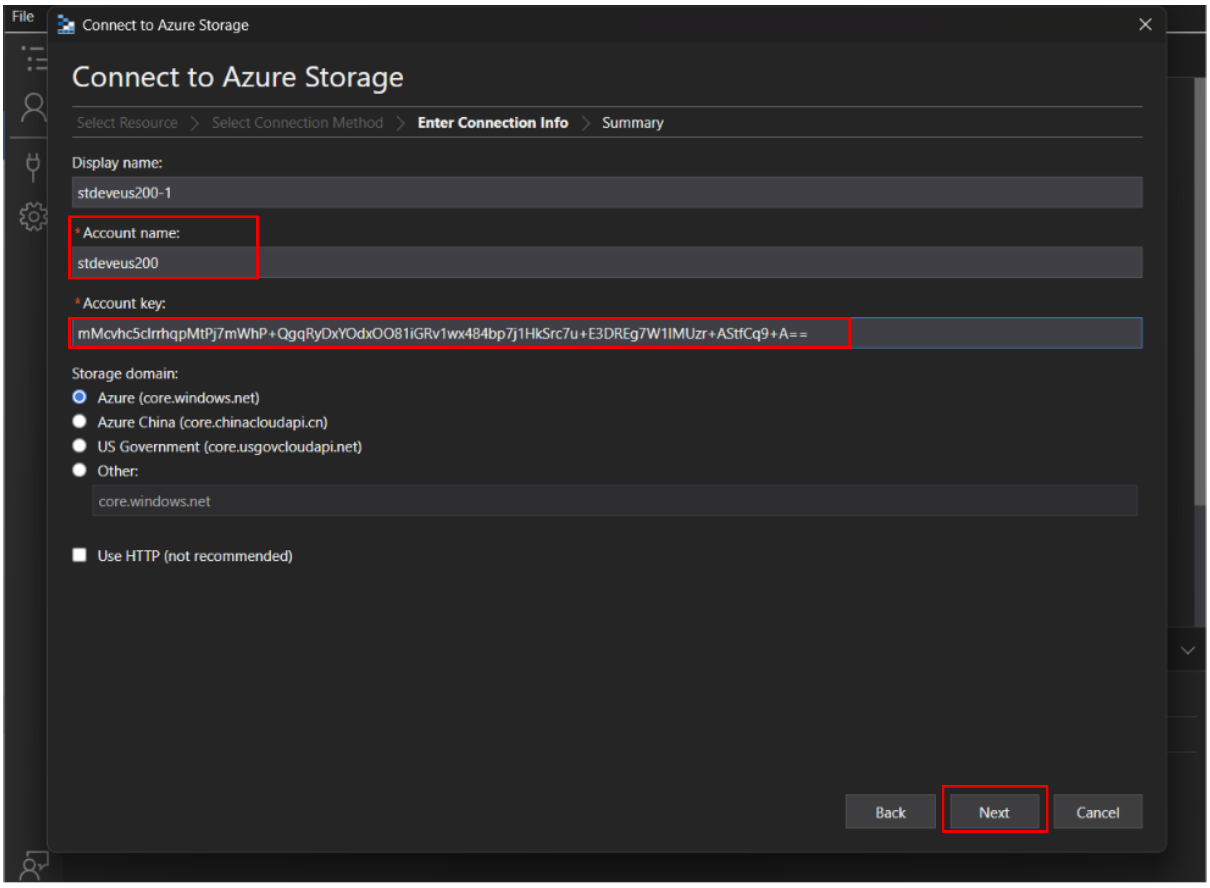
Step 5: Choose Access Key Authentication

- Select **Storage account name and key**.
- Click **Next**.



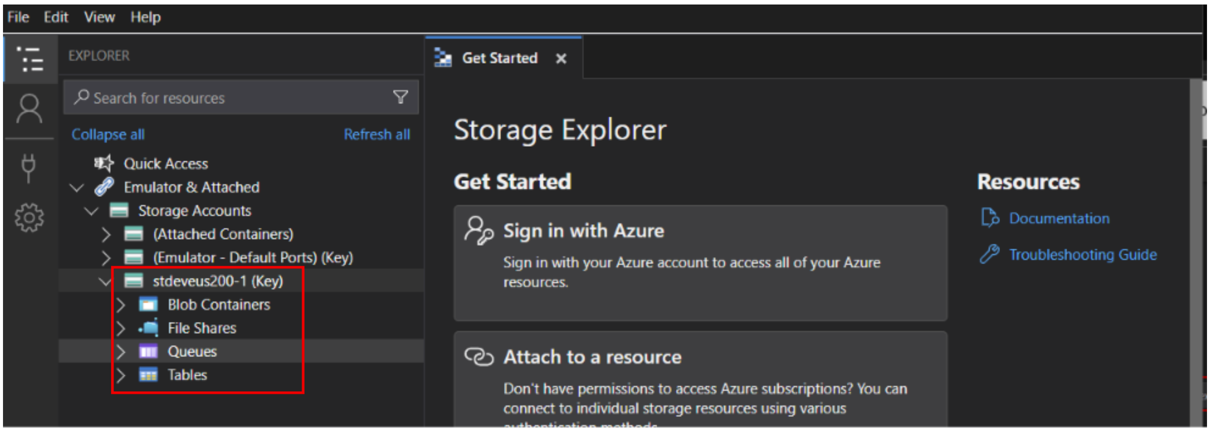
Step 6: Enter Storage Account Details

- Enter the **Storage Account Name**.
- Paste the **Access Key**.
- Give the connection a display name (optional).
- Click **Next**.
- Review the details.
- Click **Connect**.



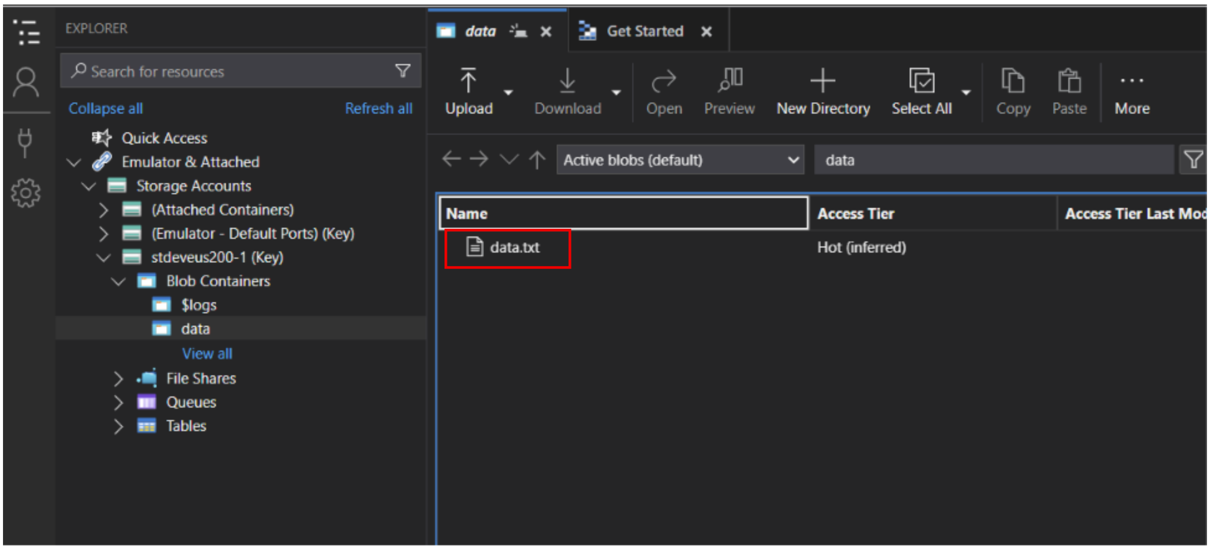
Step 7: Verify the Connection

- Expand the connected Storage Account.
- Browse the available services:
  - Blob Containers
  - File Shares
  - Queues
  - Tables
- Verify that the resources are displayed.



Step 9: Verify the Uploaded File

- Click on the **Blob Container.**
- Navigate to **Data**.
- Confirm that the uploaded blob appears in the list.



EXPLORER
data
Get Started
Search for resources
Collapse all
Refresh all
Quick Access
Emulator & Attached
Storage Accounts
(Attached Containers)
(Emulator - Default Ports) (Key)
stdeveus200-1 (Key)
Blob Containers
$logs
data
View all
File Shares
Queues
Tables
Upload
Download
Open
Preview
New Directory
Select All
Copy
Paste
More
Active blobs (default)
data
Name
Access Tier
Access Tier Last Mod
data.txt
Hot (inferred)